

HiveForce Labs

THREAT ADVISORY

 **ATTACK REPORT**

GuLoader's Advanced Anti-Analysis Techniques

Date of Publication

December 27, 2022

Admiralty Code

A1

TA Number

TA2022317

Attack: The new version of GuLoader uses new anti-analysis techniques and code injection redundancy

Attack Details

#1

GuLoader is an advanced malware downloader that uses polymorphic shellcode to bypass traditional security solutions. In GuLoader, all embedded DJB2 hash values are mapped against every API used by the malware. A new shellcode anti-analysis method scans the entire process memory for virtual machine (VM)-related strings to prevent researchers from analyzing the shellcode. A significant number of anti-analysis techniques are employed by GuLoader, making detection and protection difficult.

#2

GuLoader exhibits a multistage deployment in its recent sample: In the first stage, a VBS dropper file is used to drop a second-stage packaged payload into the registry. Then, a PowerShell script is run to execute and unpack the second-stage payload. During the second stage, the payload performs all anti-analysis routines, creates an ieinstall.exe process, and injects the same shellcode into it. This third stage carries out all the anti-analysis techniques, downloads the final payload from a remote server, and executes it on the victim's computer.

Recommendations



Security Leaders

Phishing simulations and routine education and awareness training and communications rarely account for MFA fatigue and web browser hygiene. Integrate and communicate all lessons learned.



Security Engineers

- **Uni5 Users:** This is an actionable threat advisory in HivePro Uni5. Prioritize and block all indicators attributed to the threat actors and attacks through your Command Center. Test your controls with Uni5's Breach & Attack Simulation.
- **All Engineers:** Refer to and action upon the 'Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs' & 'Indicators of Compromise (IoC)' on the following pages.

Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs

<u>TA0001</u> Initial Access	<u>TA0002</u> Execution	<u>TA0011</u> Command and Control	<u>TA0005</u> Defense Evasion
<u>TA0003</u> Persistence	<u>TA0004</u> Privilege Escalation	<u>T1106</u> Native API	<u>T1055</u> Process Injection
<u>T1059</u> Command and Scripting Interpreter	<u>T1566</u> Phishing	<u>T1574</u> Hijack Execution Flow	<u>T1140</u> Deobfuscate/Decode Files or Information
<u>T1027</u> Obfuscated Files or Information	<u>T1104</u> Multi-Stage Channels		

Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

TYPE	VALUE
SHA256	f75cefc70404640cf823fe419af6f9841c3cfee17a9fdb332da251d0964e17f
URL	https[:]//biropem[.]papuabaratprov[.]go[.]id/bin_fXZOFMVq248[.]bin

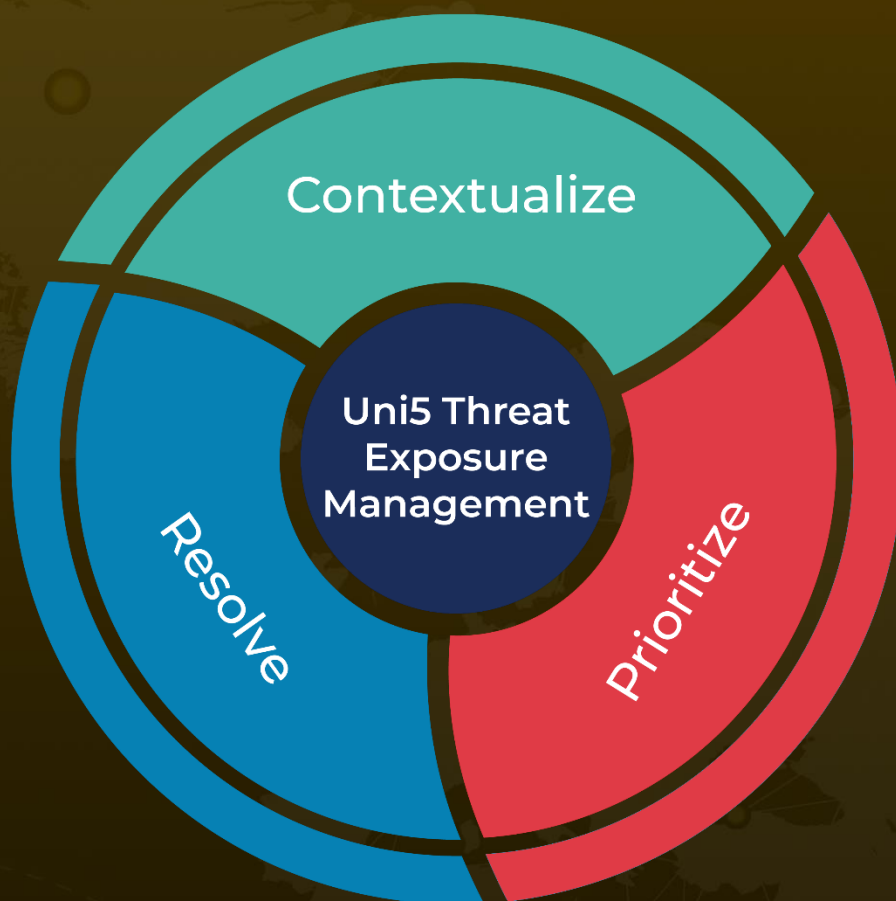
References

<https://www.crowdstrike.com/blog/guloader-dissection-reveals-new-anti-analysis-techniques-and-code-injection-redundancy/>

What Next?

At Hive Pro, it is our mission to detect the most likely threats to your organization and to help you prevent them from happening.

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